A-A-51844
31 March 1987

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

ENVELOPE, STERILIZATION

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description.

This commercial item description covers a self-sealing, paper and plastic, sterilization envelope with steam and gas sterilization indicators.

Salient characteristics:

The sterilization envelope shall be a plastic faced and paper backed peel pouch specifically designed for the containment of items during sterilization, and aseptic handling following sterilization. The envelope shall be supplied in the following approximate sizes:

Size 1 - 3-1/2 inches by 8 inches (8.9 cm by 20.3 cm)

Size 2 - 3-1/2 inches by 22 inches (8.9 cm by 55.9 cm)

The sides and top of the sterilization envelope shall have a permanent wide seal which will remain intact before, during, and after ethylene oxide or steam sterilization. The bottom of the envelope shall have a wide self seal flap which will remain intact during ethylene oxide or steam sterilization. The adhesive used for closure of the bottom flap shall be suitable for the purpose and capable of adhering only to the envelope surfaces intended.

Both the paper and plastic surfaces of the sterilization envelope shall be sufficiently permeable to permit contents to be sterilized via steam and ethylene oxide, and sufficiently impermeable after sterilization so that contamination from the atmosphere shall not enter a closed envelope.

Both surfaces of the sterilization envelope shall be strong enough to minimize wrapper perforation. The plastic surface shall be clear for easy product identification.

Each sterilization envelope shall include indicators which shall provide visual indication that the sterilization process (whether steam or gas) is complete.

AMSC N/A FSC 6530

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The sterilization envelope shall be free of tears, cuts, holes, perforations, grease, dirt, or foreign matter.

The individual pouch shall be legibly and permanently marked with the manufacturer's name and part number, the pouch size in inches, and an indication that the pouch is self-sealing, without obscuring the contents of the pouch. The markings shall be complete and legible.

Workmanship. The sterilization envelope shall be free from defects which detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability.

Unit. Package (PG). One package containing eight hundred sterilization envelopes, as specified, constitutes one unit.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contact or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as specified herein. The unit of product for test purposes shall be one sterilization envelope.

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Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Numbers are covered by this document:

Size 1 - 6530-01-163-3742
Size 2 - 6530-01-166-5073

Ordering data. Intermediate/exterior package quantities, labeling, and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order.

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A-A-51844

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD - MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

Project No. 6530-1880

PGC 58437
51149

Location: CID/ENVELOPE/H13-3

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
A-A-51844	ENVELOPE, STERILIZATION

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR ☐ USER ☐ MANUFACTURER ☐ OTHER *(Specify)* _____
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation.

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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